Senior Technology Support Program

(formerly Senior Genius Bar)

Helping seniors stay connected to the people and moments that matter most.

Hi, I'm Aiden O'Neill. I built these picture guides so you can learn at your own pace, one clear step at a time — nothing skipped, nothing assumed. Keep this booklet by your favorite chair, and don't hesitate to reach out any time you have a question.

seniorgeniusbar@gmail.com

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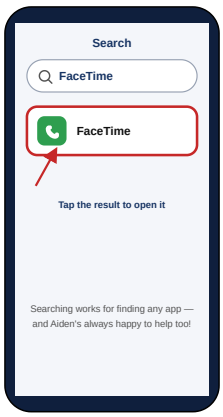
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1 Make a Video Call

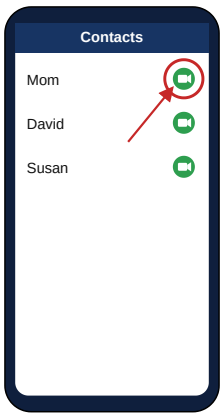
See and talk face-to-face with the people you love.

STEP 1



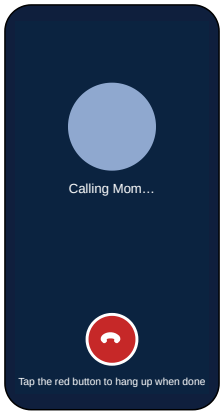
Swipe down or tap the search icon on your device, then type "FaceTime" and tap the result to open it. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Find the person you want to talk to in your list, then tap the green video-camera icon next to their name.

STEP 3

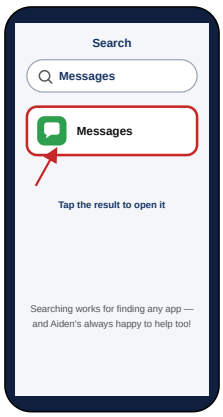


Your call will connect and you'll see their face on your screen. When you're ready to say goodbye, tap the red button to hang up.

2 Send a Text Message

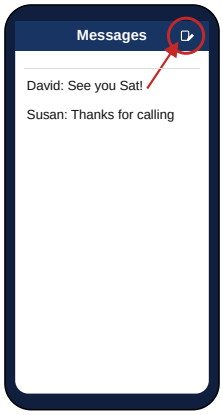
A quick way to say hello without picking up the phone.

STEP 1



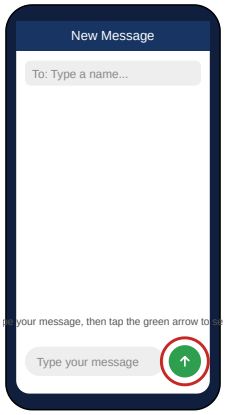
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Messages" and tap the result to open it. This trick works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Tap the compose icon in the top corner to start a brand new message.

STEP 3

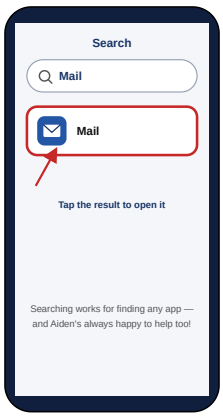


Type the person's name at the top, then type your message at the bottom and tap the green arrow to send it.

3 Check & Reply to Email

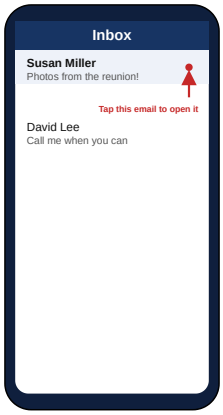
Read messages from friends and family, and write back.

STEP 1



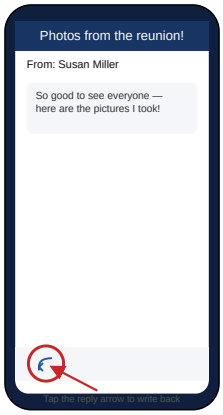
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Mail" and tap the result to see your messages. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Tap on an email in your list to open and read it.

STEP 3

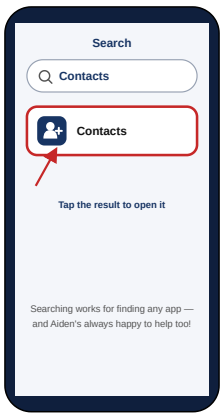


Read the message, then tap the reply arrow at the bottom to write back.

4 Add a New Contact

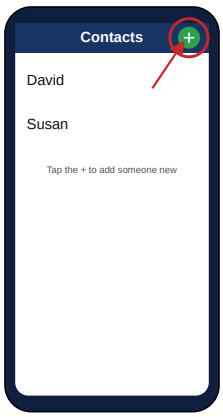
Save someone's number so you can reach them anytime.

STEP 1



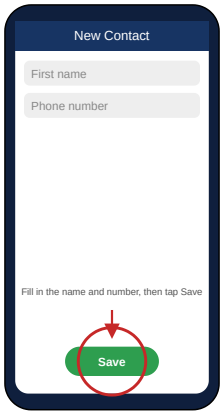
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Contacts" and tap the result to open it. This trick works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Tap the plus (+) button to add someone new.

STEP 3

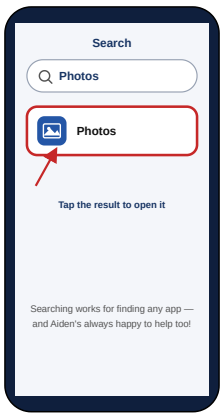


Type in their first name and phone number, then tap Save.

5 Share a Photo

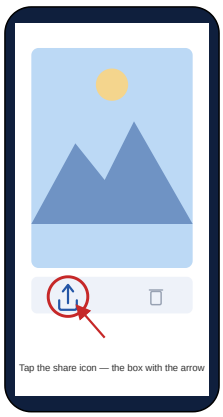
Send a favorite picture to someone who'd love to see it.

STEP 1



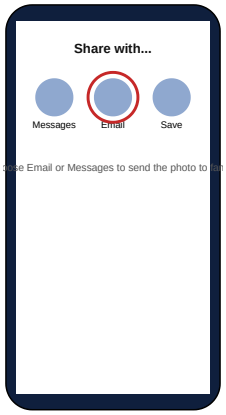
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Photos" and tap the result to open your pictures. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Open the photo you want to share, then tap the share icon — the little box with an arrow — at the bottom of the screen.

STEP 3

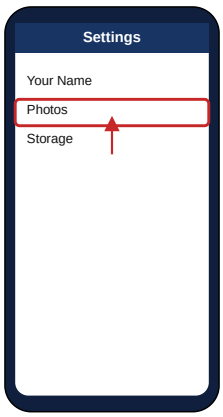


Choose Messages or Email, then pick who you want to send the photo to.

6 Back Up Your Photos

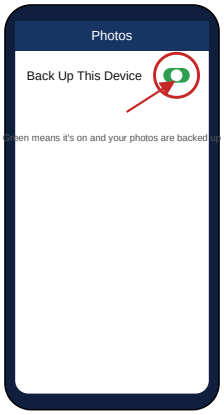
Keep your pictures safe, even if something happens to your phone.

STEP 1



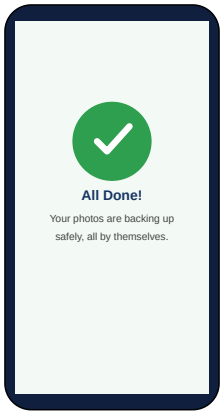
Open Settings, tap your name at the top, then tap Photos.

STEP 2



Turn on Back Up This Device. Green means it's on.

STEP 3

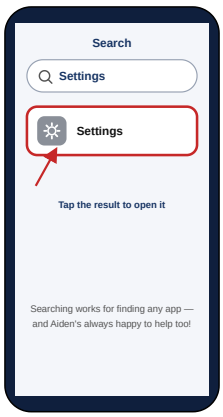


That's it — your photos will now back up safely on their own, even if something happens to your phone.

7 Make Text Bigger

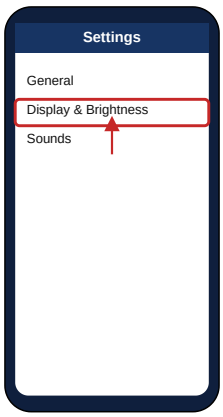
Make everything on your screen easier to read.

STEP 1



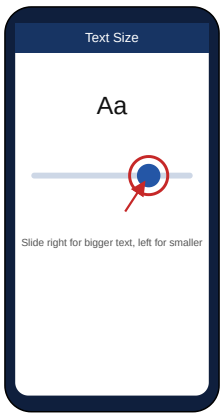
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Settings" and tap the result to open it. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Tap General, then tap Display & Brightness.

STEP 3

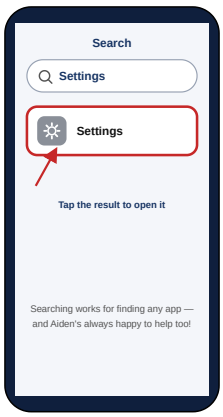


Tap Text Size, then slide it to the right to make everything on your screen bigger.

8 Connect to Wi-Fi

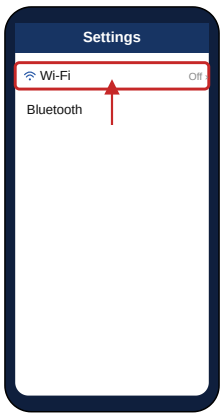
Get your device online at home.

STEP 1



Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Settings" and tap the result to open it. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



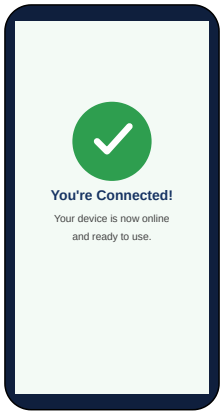
Tap Wi-Fi near the top of the list.

STEP 3



Tap your home network's name, then type in the Wi-Fi password to connect.

STEP 4

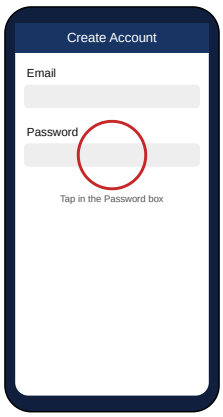


Once you're connected, you'll see a checkmark next to your network's name.

9 Create a Strong Password

Let your phone create and remember a safe password for you.

STEP 1



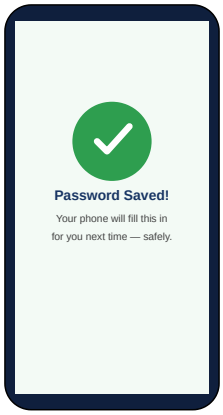
When a website or app asks you to create a password, you'll see a screen like this one.

STEP 2



Look for "Use Strong Password?" and tap Use Suggested Password — no need to make one up yourself.

STEP 3

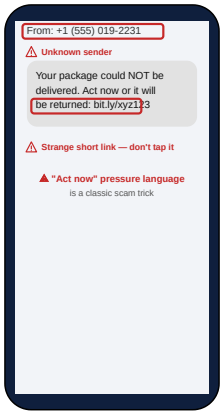


Your phone remembers this password for you, so you'll never have to.

10 Spot a Scam Text

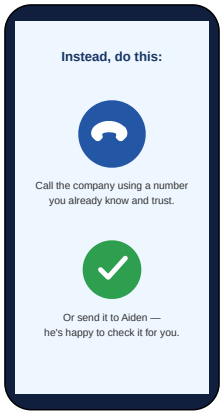
Learn to recognize a trick message — and know just what to do.

STEP 1



Real companies never rush you or ask you to click a strange link. An unexpected message with urgent language or an odd link is usually a scam.

STEP 2

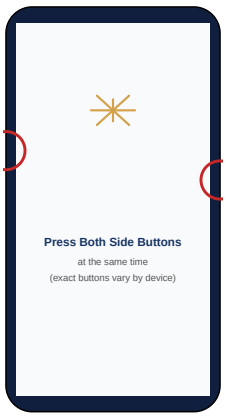


Don't tap the link. Instead, call the company using a number you already know and trust, or send it to Aiden and he'll happily check it for you.

11 Take a Screenshot and Share It

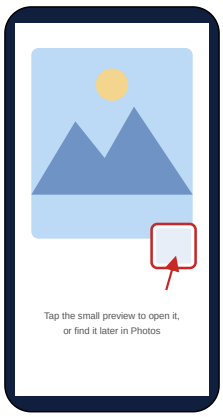
Capture what's on your screen and send it to someone in a text.

STEP 1



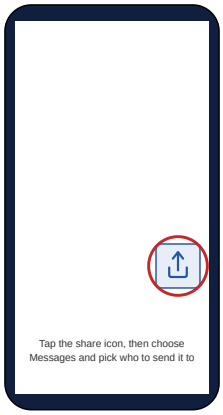
On most phones, press two buttons on the edges of the phone at the same time — often the side (power) button and the volume-up button. You'll see a quick flash and hear a click, which means it worked. This is slightly different on every device, so ask Aiden if yours looks different.

STEP 2



Your screenshot is saved automatically — usually to your Photos app. Right after you take it, you may also see a small preview appear in the corner of your screen; tap it to open it right away.

STEP 3

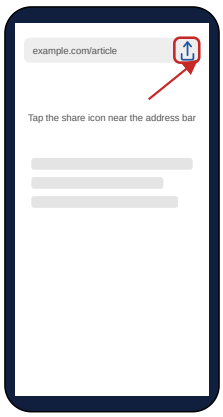


Open the screenshot, tap the share icon — the box with an arrow — then choose Messages and pick who you want to send it to.

12 Share a Link in a Text or Email

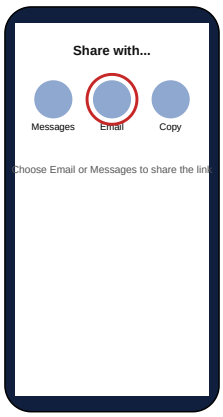
Send a webpage or article to someone else with just a couple of taps.

STEP 1



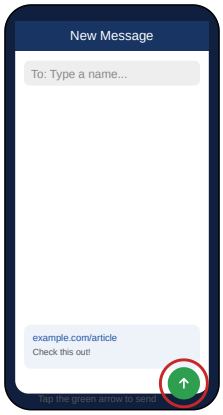
While looking at a webpage in your browser, look for the share icon — a small box with an arrow pointing up. It's usually near the address bar at the top, or along the bottom of the screen.

STEP 2



Choose Messages or Email from the share menu, then pick who you want to send it to.

STEP 3

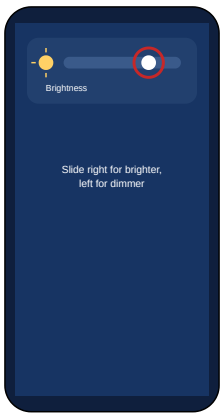


The link will appear in your message, ready to send. Pick the person, then tap the green arrow to send it.

13 Adjust Brightness and Sound

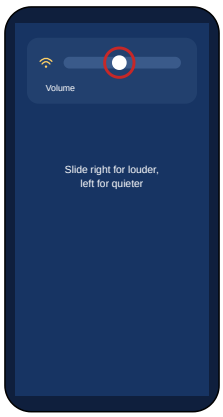
Make your screen easier to see and your phone easier to hear.

STEP 1



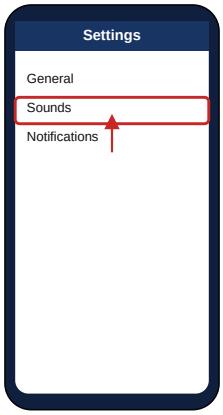
Swipe down from the top-right of your screen (or up from the bottom, depending on your device) to open quick controls, including a brightness slider shown with a sun icon.

STEP 2



In that same panel, look for the volume slider — usually shown with a speaker icon — and slide it to make your phone louder or quieter.

STEP 3

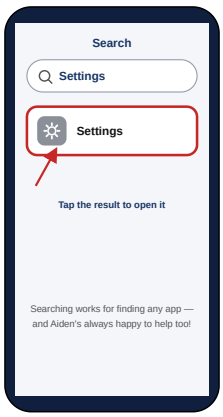


For more control over ringtones, alerts, and call volume, open Settings and tap Sounds.

14 Adjust Notifications

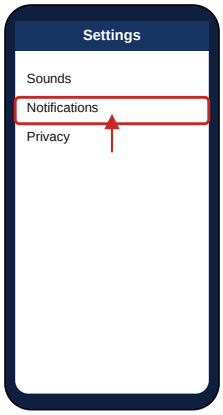
Choose which apps can send you alerts, and how loud or quiet they are.

STEP 1



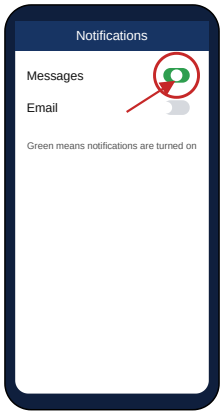
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Settings" and tap the result to open it. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Tap Notifications to see which apps are allowed to alert you.

STEP 3

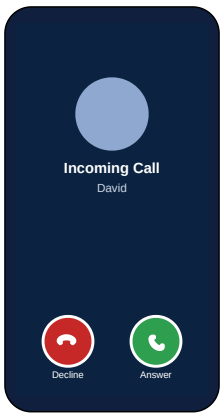


Tap an app's name, then turn its notifications on or off. Green means notifications are turned on for that app.

15 Answer or Decline a Phone Call

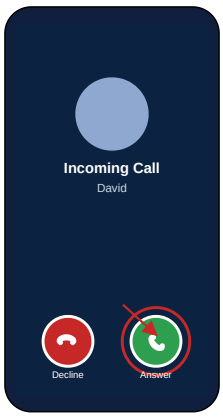
Pick up when you want to talk, or send it to voicemail if it's not a good time.

STEP 1



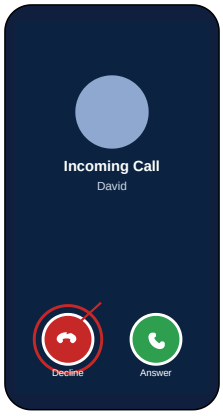
When someone calls, you'll see their name on the screen along with a green button and a red button.

STEP 2



To take the call, tap or slide the green button.

STEP 3

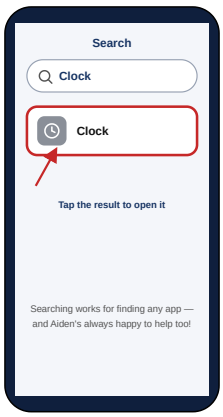


If it's not a good time, tap the red button instead — the call goes to voicemail, and they can leave you a message.

16 Set a Reminder or Alarm

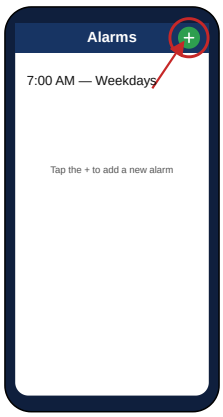
Never forget an appointment or medicine time again.

STEP 1



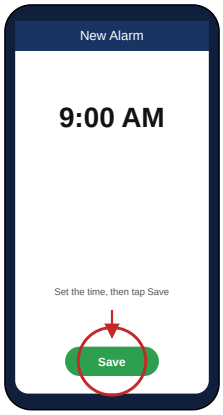
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Clock" and tap the result to open it. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Tap Alarm near the top, then tap the plus (+) button to add a new one.

STEP 3

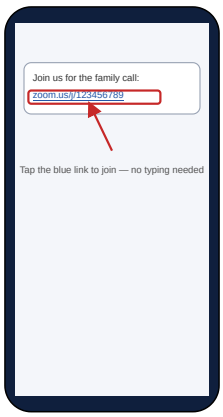


Set the time you want, then tap Save — your phone will ring at that time every day.

17 Join a Zoom Video Call

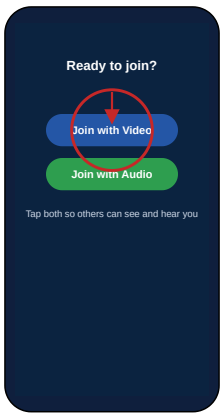
Join a video call for a class, church service, or family gathering with one tap.

STEP 1



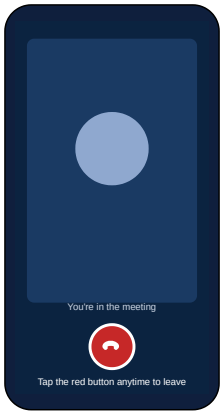
You'll usually get a link by text or email, like this one. Just tap the blue link to join — there's no need to type anything.

STEP 2



If asked, tap "Join with Video" and "Join with Audio" so the others on the call can see and hear you.

STEP 3

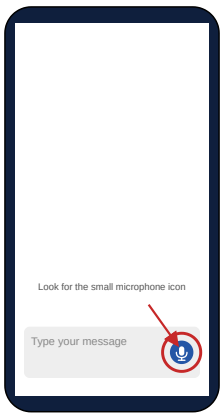


That's it — you're in the meeting! Tap the red button anytime you're ready to leave.

18 Use Voice Typing Instead of Typing

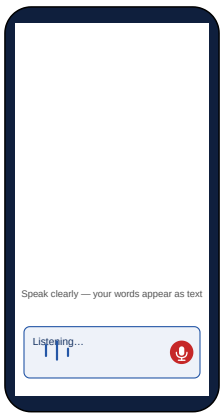
Speak your message out loud and let your phone type it for you.

STEP 1



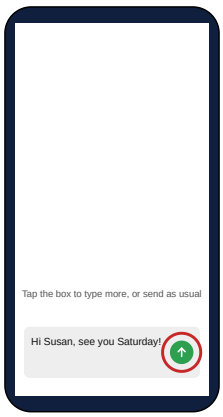
When you see a keyboard, look for the small microphone icon, usually near the spacebar.

STEP 2



Tap the microphone and start speaking clearly. Your words appear as text right on the screen.

STEP 3

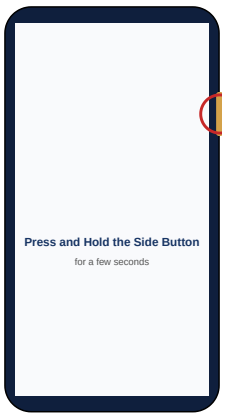


Tap the text box when you're done to go back to typing, then send your message as usual.

19 Restart Your Device

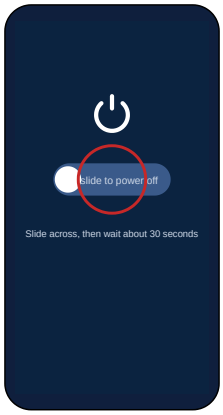
A simple trick that fixes many problems — try this first when something isn't working right.

STEP 1



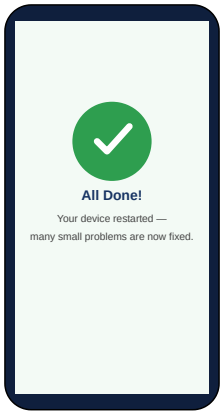
Press and hold the side (power) button for a few seconds until you see a slider or a power symbol appear.

STEP 2



Slide the power symbol (or tap Restart), then wait about 30 seconds while your device turns off and back on.

STEP 3

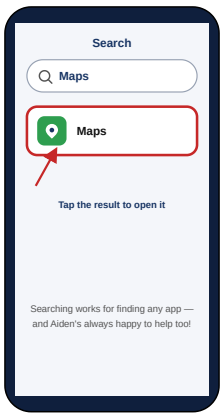


That's it — many small problems, like a frozen screen or an app acting strange, are fixed simply by restarting.

20 Get Directions with Maps

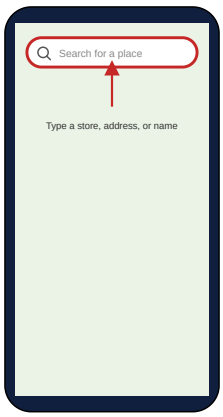
Find your way somewhere new, with turn-by-turn directions read out loud.

STEP 1



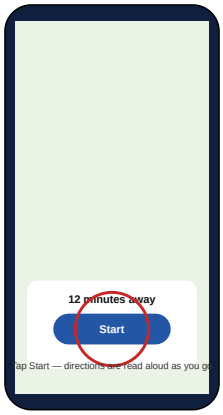
Swipe down or tap the search icon, then type "Maps" and tap the result to open it. Searching works for finding any app — and Aiden's always happy to help if you get stuck.

STEP 2



Tap the search bar at the top and type where you want to go — a store name, address, or "Dr. Smith's office" all work.

STEP 3



Tap Start — your phone will read the directions out loud as you drive or walk.

Bonus Guide: What Do These Icons Mean?

Phones and tablets use small pictures, called icons, instead of words to save space. A few icons look slightly different on an iPhone than on an Android phone; where that's true, both are shown below.

LEARN THESE THREE FIRST



Settings

Opens your phone or app's settings, where you can change how things work.



iPhone Android

More Options

Opens a list of more choices, like Delete, Share, or Edit.



Search

Opens a search box so you can find an app, contact, or setting by typing its name.

Getting Around



Menu
Opens a hidden menu with more sections or options, usually from a corner of the screen.



iPhone Android

Go Back
Takes you back to the screen you were just on.



Close
Closes the current screen, pop-up, or search box without saving changes.



Home
Takes you to your phone's main Home Screen, or an app's main page.

Doing Things



Add
Starts adding something new, like a contact, event, or message.



Edit
Lets you change or write text that's already there.



Delete
Removes the item for good — make sure before you tap it.



iPhone



Android

Share
Opens a list of ways to send something to someone else, like by text, email, or another app.



Attach
Lets you add a photo or file to a message.



Send
Sends your message, photo, or file.

Sound, Voice & Alerts



Sound On



Muted

Volume / Mute
Shows and controls how loud the sound is, or mutes it completely.



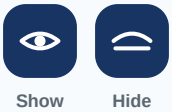
Talk Instead of Type
Lets you speak instead of typing — tap it and say what you want to write.



Notifications
Shows alerts and messages waiting for your attention.

Safety & Status

Secure / Locked
Means the page or connection is safe, or that your phone is locked.



Show / Hide Password
Tap to reveal the password you typed, so you can check it is correct.

Wi-Fi Signal
Shows how strong your internet connection is.

Bluetooth
Means your phone can connect wirelessly to things like hearing aids, wireless earbuds, a speaker, or your car.

Battery
Shows how much charge is left on your device.